popular struggles in central countries, that system would not have lasted. For at least 30 years, between 1945 and 1975, an intense process of change took place from traditional imperialism to capital-imperialism,[6] which modified some of the characteristics initially analysed by Lenin without, however, overturning them. Given that he edited the pamphlet on imperialism before the existence of the Soviet Union, Lenin could not have foreseen the first change. For the United States, the great capitalist winner, the constitution of two opposing blocs meant a dislocation of its theatre of operations and its target of hostility. From then on, new types of alliances had to be built among capitalist countries, including the support of a winning country for the defeated, never before seen or reproduced (instead of the traditional and historically legitimate – even if tragic – imposition of reparations). These alliances were tied together by a common, though nuanced, preventive anti-communist strategy.[7] This unequal interlocking of capitals is the first feature of capital-imperialism to highlight.

Leo Panitch and Sam Gindin (2012) analyse US centrality as the result of an early power project openly defined as an 'informal empire'. This has many affinities with the argument here; nevertheless, in my judgement these authors attribute too much weight to the official US position – expressed by state officials, intellectuals and big businessmen – and give little emphasis to social struggles within and outside of the United States and their unforeseen or even desired impacts. Besides, they consider Lenin's arguments wrong regarding the necessarily warlike inter-imperialist rivalry. In my opinion, the concentration of US economic and military power does not allow one to discard the possibility of new inter-imperialist wars. On the contrary, it stimulates tensions even if the wars occur under new and carefully local forms. Nevertheless, the authors' rich analysis helps to verify the hypothesis regarding the informal empire preparing and justifying the particular inter-imperialist interconnection under US predominance that results in capital-imperialism.

In my view, even though there are disparate (and conflicting) positions among entrepreneurs, intellectuals and government sectors about the strategies to adopt, capital-imperialism is not the result of a consensus or a 'decision' but rather of a particular situation derived from the already cited specific characteristics at the end of the war. Out of this situation capital's expansive pressures arose, in that special context of containing the USSR (and, in turn, China and Cuba) and of constant counterrevolution, which accelerated the take-off of the so-called multinational corporations, associating even more profoundly the principal capitalist countries under US primacy. Associations, cartels and the internationalisation of firms did not start there; rather, what did begin was their contemporary design and